

Glory to God in the Highest!

Saracoff Sentinel/Team Tijuana

December, 2005

Points for Prayer

- May Good News go out in Christmas fiestas, services, words/deeds.
- Ministry leaders to balance work and family time; discernment as they face overwhelming needs.
- May Spanish-speaking Moms in Touch prayer groups multiply.
- God's healing touch on broken families; may his love flow through us to others who are hurting, especially at Christmas.
- God's provision of industrial stove, electrical transformer and funding for funerals at Home for Elderly.
- Wisdom and God's choice of people to work with as we begin Micro Enterprise Development.
- Guidance as Ian considers colleges.
- Greg's dad had a serious heart attack 11/29. Pray for the family. We don't know if he'll survive.

Latin America Mission

P.O. Box 52-7900

Miami, FL 33152-7900

Please indicate:

Saracoff Ministry

We invite you to visit:
www.lam.org

www.teamtijuana.org



Let us hear from you!

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A Review of 2005— Many Reasons to Praise God!

*"Give thanks to the
Lord, for he is good"*
Psalm 107:1

La Roca retaining
wall completed.

Elderly Home gets
new rooms for
women.

Esperanza's new
dorm for women at
the Drug Rehabilita-
tion Center fills up
and is expanding.

Eye Team hands out
hundreds of pairs of
glasses in November

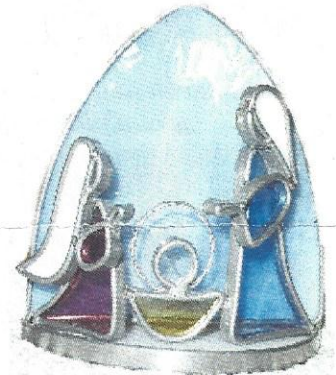
**Sales of stained
glass** encourage men
in Rehab program.

Campo de Fe gets
adopted by local
men's group who
take on finishing
the addition.

Churches from
MN, TX, CA, and
Canada send teams
that bless many in
Tijuana.

"Perspectives"
course on missions
taken by Greg &
Kathy (who highly
recommends it).

Kids for Kids race,
Golf Tournament,
and Sports Jam raise
much-needed funds
for Tijuana ministry



Nativity made by Rehab

Saracoffs attend
LAM Mexico retreat

Kathy sees 100 yr.
old Grandmother
Dennis before Jesus
takes her home.

God's Family from
both sides of the
border—visitors,
interns, students,
families, pastors, all
working together for
Jesus!

Christmas Tree Circle: Our Circle of Influence by Kathy

Every year, a couple
weeks before Christ-
mas, the street we
live on changes its
name to "*Christmas
Tree Circle*." It be-
comes a California-
style winter won-
derland of lights,
fanciful decorations

and some neighborly
rivalry as we prepare
for the hordes of
holiday sightseers.
Sometimes I shudder
at the skewed views
Christmas, the gross

materialism, the peer
pressure. But it oc-
curs to me that Jesus
said, "*Let your light
shine before men, that
they may see your
good works and praise
your heavenly Father*"
(Mt 5:16) What an
opportunity to obey!



Tijuana One Day Missions



Dan, Sarah and Felicia from Alvarez' group play with kids



by **Sandi Alvarez** of Paseo del Rey Church in Chula Vista

About two years ago our family started praying for the opportunity to serve specifically in Tijuana, Mexico. Everywhere we turned the doors seemed to close for us. Just a few weeks prior to our church's picnic in the park, we had resumed our prayer requests for serving in Tijuana. At the picnic, Hector met Greg Saracoff. Greg shared his involvement with the Latin America Mission and how they work with several faith-based projects in Mexico. That summer our family went down to La Roca, a refuge for homeless children and mothers. We painted, did carpentry work, helped in kitchen, did crafts with the children and met some real nice people. The Lord had opened the door, not on our timing, but His! A few weeks later we shared our experience with our church family. Since that time, we have been to Tijuana 3 times, taking with us others from the church. The Lord also moved the hearts of a group of church women to commit to praying for these trips and providing some of the needed supplies.

We are currently working with two projects: La Roca, where we encourage the volunteers, mothers and children who live there; and The Kids Club, which is more of an outreach opportunity (in Grupo Mexico). Our next trip is Dec. 17th, going to the Kids Club to share the gospel with crafts, games, and drama. We invite you to join us!

Developing Character and Self-sufficiency through Micro Finance

*"When work presents
an opportunity,
some turn up their sleeves
some turn up their noses
some do not turn up at all."*

(from the internet)

It's easy for folks in Tijuana to show up for the hand-outs but those with the spark of self-determination are willing to roll up their sleeves. It is true that some do not have the initiative or intelligence to start a small business, but many do. Don't you think those with this desire should find help to advance? We do!

With the help of Robert Grego from Costa Rica and John

Noordenbos (CEO of FIPS—Fundación para la Integración Productiva Sustentable, AC), we have been working to start MED (Micro Enterprise Development) in Tijuana. In our last newsletter we outlined our basic plan to start two community groups of 20 people each.

As with all good plans, we face some obstacles. The two that have stalled us out for the moment are Mexican paperwork and the lack of funds. Our paperwork will be greatly reduced by becoming a branch of FIPS. FIPS has over 3500 women involved in Guanajuato and Oaxaca. Their president John "Noorde" is based out of San Diego. He spends two

weeks here and two weeks in Mexico. Having John in the area can give us some experienced help. We'll send our man Napoleon to Mexico City for some additional hands-on training before we start. November was too soon to get things in order and we still lack all the funding. We have about half of what we need. Lord willing, we hope for a start in early 2006. Your prayers are coveted for this project.



If you want to learn more about MED, may we suggest reading Kingdom Business by David Befus (LAM president). Available through LAM website.